“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 3

The Glories of Haridāsa Ṭhākura

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I bow down to the beautiful lotus feet of my śrī guru, to the śrī gurus and to the Vaiṣṇavas; to Śrī Rūpa, together with his elder brother (Sanātana), with Raghunātha and his companions and with Jīva; to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva, together with Advaita, with the Avadhūta (Nityānanda) and with His associates; and to the feet of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, together with Their companions, Lalitā and Śrī Viśākhā.

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 In Puruṣottama there lived an Oriyā brāhmaṇa boy, fatherless, very handsome and gentle in his manner.

4 Every day he came to the Lord and offered Him obeisance. He would talk with the Lord, for the Lord was his very ‘life’.

5 The boy loved the Lord, and the Lord was kind to him; but Dāmodara could not tolerate the boy’s affection.

6 Again and again he forbade the brāhmaṇa boy to come, but the boy could not stay away without seeing the Lord.

7 He came every day, and the Lord treated him with great affection. A child goes where he is loved — such is the way of children.

8 Seeing this, Dāmodara was troubled at heart, yet he could say nothing more, for the boy would not heed his prohibition.

9 One day the boy came to the Lord again, and the Lord affectionately asked him how he was.

10 After a while, when the boy got up and left, Dāmodara could bear it no longer and began to speak.

11 He said to the Lord, “When it comes to instructing others, You are a *paṇḍita*, and everyone hails You, ‘Gosāñi! Gosāñi!’ Now we shall see what kind of ‘Gosāñi’ You are.

12 Now all the people will sing the Gosāñi’s qualities, and the Gosāñi’s fame will spread all over Puruṣottama!”

13 Hearing this, the Lord said, “What are you saying, Dāmodara?” Dāmodara said, “You are the independent Lord.

14 You behave as You please — who can say anything to You? But can You cover the mouth of the talkative world?

15 You are a *paṇḍita* — why do You not consider this? Why do You show such affection to the son of a widowed brāhmaṇī?

16 Although that brāhmaṇī is austere and chaste, she has one fault: she is young and beautiful.

17 And You too are very young and very handsome. You are giving people occasion for gossip.”

18 Having said this, Dāmodara fell silent. The Lord, pleased at heart, smiled and reflected:

19 “This I call a wave of pure love. I have no intimate associate like Dāmodara.”

20 Reflecting thus, the Lord went to attend to His midday duties. The next day He called Dāmodara to Him in private.

21 The Lord said, “Dāmodara, go to Nadīyā. Go there and stay near My mother.

22 She has no protector other than you, for you have cautioned even Me.

23 Among My associates there is no one as impartial (*nirapekṣa*) as you, and without impartiality *dharma* cannot be protected.

24 What I cannot do, you can. You have chastised even Me — what then of anyone else?

25 Go and stay in My mother’s house, at her feet. Before you no one will dare to behave as he pleases.

26 From time to time you may come to see Me, but then go back there quickly.

27 Convey to My mother My obeisances millions of times, and give her joy by telling her the happy news of Me.

28 Tell her: ‘The Lord has sent me here to tell you His news constantly.’

29 Saying this, bring satisfaction to My mother’s heart. And remind her of a confidential matter:

30 ‘Again and again I come to your house and eat all the sweets and vegetable dishes.

31 I do eat them, and you know it; but in the external state of separation you take it to be only a vision (*sphūrti*).

32 This Māgha-saṅkrānti you did the cooking: you made various vegetable dishes, condensed milk, cakes and sweet rice.

33 When you had offered the food to Kṛṣṇa and were meditating, I appeared to you, and your eyes filled with tears.

34 I went in haste and ate everything, and when you saw Me eating, joy arose in you.

35 A moment later, wiping your tears, you saw that the plate was empty and thought, “I have had a dream that Nimāi ate the rice.”

36 In that state of external separation you were confused again and thought, “I have not offered the food.”

37 You looked in the cooking pots and saw that they were all full of food. So, having cleansed the place, you offered the food again.

38 In this way I eat again and again; your pure love draws Me.

39 It is by your order that I stay in Nīlācala, yet by the power of your love you draw Me close to you.’

40 Remind her in this way again and again, and worship her feet in My name.”

41 Saying this, the Lord had Jagannātha's *prasāda* brought and gave it to him in separate portions for His mother and for the Vaiṣṇavas.

42 Then Dāmodara set out and came to Nadīyā. He met the Lord's mother and remained at her feet.

43 He gave the *mahā-prasāda* to the Ācārya (Advaita) and the other Vaiṣṇavas. Just as the Lord had ordered, so the Paṇḍita did.

44 Before Dāmodara no one dared to act independently; out of fear of him everyone behaved with restraint.

45 Whenever he saw any of the Lord's associates commit even a slight breach of propriety, he chastised him with words and so established proper conduct.

46 Thus I have told of Dāmodara's chastisement with words; by hearing of it, ignorance and atheism (*pāṣaṇḍa*) flee.

47 Caitanya's pastimes are deeper than millions of oceans. No one can understand what He does or why.

48 Therefore I know nothing of their hidden meaning; I struggle just to give them an external meaning.

49 One day the Lord met Haridāsa, and as they conversed He asked him:

50 "Haridāsa, in the age of Kali the *yavanas* are countless. They are very wicked and do violence to cows and brāhmaṇas.

51 How will all of them be delivered? I see no means for it, and this grief of Mine is boundless."

52 Haridāsa said, “Lord, do not worry. Do not grieve at the sight of the *yavanas*’ worldly bondage (*saṁsāra*).

53 All the *yavanas* will attain ‘liberation’ easily, for they say ‘hā rāma, hā rāma’ and so utter the semblance of the Name (*nāmābhāsa*).

54 In great love a devotee cries, ‘Hā Rāma! Hā Rāma!’ See the good fortune of the *yavanas*: they utter that very Name!

55 Although the Name is only *nāmābhāsa* when it points (*saṅketa*) to something else, its potency is still not destroyed.

56 “A *mleccha* struck by a boar’s tusk who cries ‘hā rāma’ again and again attains liberation even by saying so. What then of one who chants the Name with faith?” (Nṛsiṁha Purāṇa)

57 Ajāmila called his son by saying ‘Nārāyaṇa’, and the messengers of Viṣṇu came and released him from his bonds.

58 In ‘hā rāma’ the two syllables of ‘Rāma’ are not separated, and they are adorned with the word ‘hā’, which expresses love.

59 Such is the nature of the syllables of the Name: even when separated, they do not give up their power.

60 “O brāhmaṇa, if even one Name is on someone’s tongue, or has entered the path of his memory, or has reached the root of his ear — whether its sounds are pure or impure — and is free from separation, it certainly delivers him; this is the truth. But if that Name is placed amid concerns for the body, wealth and followers, amid greed or godlessness (*pāṣaṇḍa*), it will not quickly bear its fruit here.” (Padma Purāṇa; Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 11.289)

61 Through *nāmābhāsa* all sins are destroyed; through *nāmābhāsa* worldly existence comes to an end.

62 “O treasure of virtues, with your mind delighting in faith, quickly and without deceit worship Him, the purifier of all purifiers, the crown of those whose glory is sung in the finest verses. Ah! When even the faint light of the sun of His Name rises in the cave of the heart, it dispels the massed darkness of great sins.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.103)

63 “Even Ajāmila reached the Lord’s abode by uttering the Name of Hari as he was dying, though he addressed it to his son. What then of one who utters the Name with faith?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 6.2.49)

64 In all the scriptures I see that ‘liberation’ comes through *nāmābhāsa*, and in the Śrī Bhāgavata Ajāmila is the witness to it.”

65 Hearing this, the Lord felt His happiness grow within. Yet again, as if testing him, He asked:

66 “On the earth there are many living beings, nonmoving and moving. How will all of them be released?”

67 Haridāsa said, “Lord, that is by Your mercy: You have already delivered the nonmoving and moving beings.

68 You have performed this loud *saṅkīrtana*, and the nonmoving and moving beings have all heard it.

69 By hearing it, the moving beings are freed from worldly existence; and when that sound strikes the nonmoving beings, an echo arises.

70 It is not an ‘echo’: they are performing ‘*kīrtana*’. This is an indescribable account of Your mercy.

71 Throughout the world there is loud *saṅkīrtana*, and hearing it, the nonmoving and moving beings dance, absorbed in *prema*.

72 Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya has told me how You did this in Jhārikhaṇḍa on Your way to Vṛndāvana.

73 When Vāsudeva petitioned You on behalf of the *jīvas*, You agreed to release them.

74 This descent of Yours is to deliver the world; for that purpose You first accepted the mood of a devotee.

75 So You spread loud *saṅkīrtana* and cut off the worldly existence of all *jīvas*, nonmoving and moving."

76 The Lord said, "If all the *jīvas* attain liberation, then this universe will be empty of *jīvas*!"

77–78 Haridāsa said, "As long as You remain in the mortal world, You will liberate all the nonmoving and moving beings of every species and send them to Vaikuṇṭha. Then You will awaken the subtle *jīvas* (*sūkṣma-jīva*) to *karma* once again.

79 Those *jīvas* will become the nonmoving and moving beings here, and with them the universe will be filled as before.

80 Just as formerly Raghunātha (Rāmacandra) took all of Ayodhyā with Him to Vaikuṇṭha and filled Ayodhyā with other *jīvas*,

81 so You too, having descended, have set up a market in the same way. No one can understand Your hidden drama.

82 Formerly, when Kṛṣṇa descended in Vraja, He cut off the worldly existence of all the *jīvas* in the universe.

83 “You should not be astonished at this in the case of Kṛṣṇa, the unborn Lord, the Lord of the lords of *yoga*, by whom this whole world is liberated.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.29.16)

84 “When this Bhagavān is seen, glorified or remembered even with persistent enmity, He bestows a fruit hard to attain for all the gods, demons and others. What then of those who have perfect devotion?” (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 4.15.17)

85 Likewise, You have descended in Navadvīpa and delivered the *jīvas* of the whole universe.

86 If someone says, ‘The glory of Caitanya is within my grasp,’ let him know it; but my own conviction is this:

87 Your pastimes are an ocean of great nectar, and not even a single drop of it is within the reach of my mind.”

88 Hearing this, the Lord was amazed at heart: “How has Haridāsa come to know My hidden pastimes?”

89 In the satisfaction of His heart He embraced him, but He avoided revealing this outwardly.

90 It is the Lord’s nature to wish to conceal His majesty, but He cannot hide it from His devotees: to them it becomes known.

91 “Your sovereign nature transcends the three kinds of limits and admits of no equal or superior. Though You hide it by the power of Your māyā, some who are devoted to You alone see it constantly.” (Stotra-ratna, 18)

92 Then Mahāprabhu went to His own devotees and spoke of Haridāsa's qualities as if He had a hundred mouths.

93 The Lord's delight grows when He speaks of a devotee's qualities — and Śrī Haridāsa, moreover, is the best of all devotees.

94 Haridāsa's qualities are countless and boundless. One may describe some portion of them, but no one reaches their end.

95 In the *Caitanya-maṅgala* (the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*) Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa has revealed some of Haridāsa's qualities.

96 It is impossible to tell all of Haridāsa's character; one tells a little of it to purify oneself.

97 O devotees, hear of some of Haridāsa's qualities that Vṛndāvana dāsa did not describe.

98 When Haridāsa left his home, he lived for some time in the forest of Benāpola.

99 He built a hut in the solitary forest, served Tulasī, and night and day chanted three hundred thousand Names.

100 He lived on alms taken in brāhmaṇas' houses, and by his spiritual power he won the reverence of all the people.

101 The ruler of that district was named Rāmacandra Khān. He hated the Vaiṣṇavas and was the chief of the atheists.

102 He could not tolerate that the people revered Haridāsa, and he contrived various means to dishonor him.

103 Unable to find any fault in Haridāsa by any means, he brought in prostitutes and schemed to create one.

104 He said to the prostitutes, “There is a renunciant, Haridāsa. All of you, destroy his vow of renunciation.”

105 Among the prostitutes was a beautiful young woman. She said, “In three days I shall captivate his mind.”

106 Khān said, “Let my constable go with you, so that he may seize him together with you and bring him here.”

107 The prostitute said, “Let him first be with me once. The second time I shall take your constable to seize him.”

108 At night the prostitute dressed herself finely and went to Haridāsa’s dwelling, full of delight.

109 She bowed to Tulasī, went to Haridāsa’s door, bowed to the Gosāñi and stood there.

110 Uncovering her body to display it, she sat down at the door and began to speak in a very sweet voice:

111 “Ṭhākura, you are most handsome and in the first bloom of youth. What woman could keep her composure on seeing you?

112 My heart longs for union with you. If I do not have you, I cannot go on living.”

113–114 Haridāsa said, “I shall accept you. But until I have finished chanting my fixed number of Names, sit here and listen to the *saṅkīrtana* of the Name. When the Name is finished, I shall do as you wish.”

115 Hearing this, the prostitute sat and waited. Haridāsa went on chanting until morning came.

116 Seeing that it was morning, the prostitute got up and left, and she told Rāmacandra Khān the news:

117 “He has given his word that he will be with me today. I shall certainly be united with him.”

118 The next day, when night fell, the prostitute came, and Haridāsa reassured her warmly:

119 “Yesterday you were disappointed; please do not hold it against me. I shall certainly accept you.

120 Until then, sit here and listen to the *saṅkīrtana* of the Name. When the Name is complete, your desire will be fulfilled.”

121 Then the prostitute bowed to Tulasī, sat down at the door and listened to the Name, saying, ‘Hari! Hari!’

122 As the night was ending, the prostitute grew restless. Seeing her manner, Haridāsa said to her:

123 “I have taken a vow to perform a sacrifice of chanting ten million Names in one month, and it is now nearing its end.

124 I thought it would be finished today. I chanted the Name the whole night, yet it was not completed.

125 Tomorrow it will be finished, and then my vow will be over. Then I shall freely be with you.”

126 The prostitute went and told Khān the news. The next day she came to the Ṭhākura in the evening.

127 Bowing to Tulasī and to the Ṭhākura, she sat at the door and listened to the Name, saying, ‘Hari! Hari!’

128 “Today the Name will be completed,” said Haridāsa. “Then I shall fulfill your desire.”

129 As he chanted, the night came to an end; and through the Ṭhākura’s company the prostitute’s heart was transformed.

130 She fell flat at the Ṭhākura’s feet and confessed Rāmacandra Khān’s plot.

131 “Being a prostitute, I have committed boundless sins. Be merciful and deliver this fallen soul.”

132 The Ṭhākura said, “I know all about Khān’s plot. He is an ignorant fool, and I feel no grief on his account.

133 I would have left this place that very day; I stayed three days for your sake.”

134 The prostitute said, “Be merciful and instruct me: what must I do to be freed from the suffering of material existence?”

135 The Ṭhākura said, “Give away the goods of your house to brāhmaṇas, and then come and live in this hut.

136 Chant the Name constantly and serve Tulasī. Then you will very soon attain the feet of Kṛṣṇa.”

137 Saying this, he instructed her in chanting the Name. Then the Ṭhākura rose and departed, calling, “Hari! Hari!”

138 Then the prostitute accepted her guru’s order and gave to the brāhmaṇas whatever wealth she had in her house.

139 She shaved her head and stayed in that hut with a single cloth, chanting three hundred thousand names day and night.

140 She served Tulasī, ate sparingly or fasted. Her senses were subdued, and love (*prema*) appeared in her.

141 She became a renowned and most exalted Vaiṣṇavī, and great Vaiṣṇavas would go to see her.

142 Seeing the conduct of the former prostitute, people were amazed, and bowing down, they spoke of Haridāsa’s glory.

143 Rāmacandra Khān sowed the seed of an offence; that seed grew into a tree and later bore its fruit.

144 The fruit of an offence against a great soul makes a wonderful account. Since the occasion has come, I shall tell it; listen, O devotees.

145 Rāmacandra Khān was by nature no Vaiṣṇava, and by his offence against Haridāsa he became like a demon.

146 He reviled the religion of the Vaiṣṇavas and insulted the Vaiṣṇavas, and for the offences of many days he received the consequence.

147 When Nityānanda Gosāñi came to Gauḍa, He began to travel about, preaching love of God.

148 To preach love and to crush the unbelievers — for these two tasks the Avadhūta wandered.

149 The all-knowing Nityānanda came to his house and sat down on the *durgā-maṇḍapa*, the pavilion for the worship of Durgā.

150 The many people with Him filled the courtyard, and from inside the house Rāmacandra sent a servant.

151 The servant said, “Gosāñi, the Khān has sent me. I shall give You lodging in a householder’s house.

152 A cowherd’s cowshed is very spacious, but this place is narrow, and Your people are countless.”

153 Gosāñi had been sitting within. Hearing this, He came out in anger and, laughing loudly, began to speak:

154 “He speaks the truth: this house is not fit for Me. It is fit for the *mlecchas*, who slaughter cows.”

155 Saying this, Gosāñi rose in anger and left. To punish him, He did not stay in that village.

156 Meanwhile Rāmacandra Khān ordered a servant to dig up the earth where Gosāñi had sat.

157 He had the whole temple and courtyard smeared with cow-dung water, yet Rāmacandra’s mind was still not satisfied.

158 Rāmacandra lived like a robber and did not pay the king his taxes. Angered, the *mleccha* minister came to his house.

159 Coming there, he lodged in that very *durgā-maṇḍapa*; he slaughtered what must never be killed and cooked its meat in the house.

160 He bound Rāmacandra together with his wife and sons, and staying three days, he plundered his house and village.

161 For three days he cooked unclean food in that house, and on the next day he left, taking them all with him.

162 He took everything from the Khān — his caste, his wealth and his people — and the village lay desolate for many days.

163 Wherever a great soul is dishonoured, in a land or a village, the whole land is laid waste for the fault of a single person.

164 Walking on, Haridāsa Ṭhākura came to Cāḍapura and stayed in the house of Balarāma Ācārya.

165 Hiraṇya and Govardhana were the Majumadāras, the keepers of the revenue accounts, of the district, and their priest was named Balarāma.

166 He had received Haridāsa's mercy, and so, with devotion and respect, he carefully kept the Ṭhākura in that village.

167 He chanted in a solitary hut of leaves and took his alms (*bhikṣā*) at Balarāma Ācārya's house.

168 Raghunātha dāsa, then a boy at his studies, would go to see Haridāsa Ṭhākura.

169 Haridāsa bestowed his mercy upon him, and that mercy became the cause of his attaining Caitanya.

170 Listen, O devotees, to the wonderful account of the discussion about Haridāsa that took place there.

171 One day, after humbly entreating him, Balarāma brought the Ṭhākura to the assembly of the Majumadāras.

172 Seeing the Ṭhākura, the two brothers rose to greet him; they fell at his feet and respectfully offered him a seat.

173 In the assembly were many scholars, brāhmaṇas and gentlemen, and the two brothers, Hiraṇya and Govardhana, were themselves great scholars.

174 Everyone praised Haridāsa's virtues as if with five mouths, and hearing this, the two brothers were very happy.

175 The Ṭhākura chanted three hundred thousand names, and so the scholars raised the subject of the glory of the Name.

176 One said, "From the Name comes the destruction of sins." Another said, "From the Name the soul attains liberation."

177 Haridāsa said, "These two are not the fruit of the Name. The fruit of the Name is that love for Kṛṣṇa's feet arises.

178 "One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)

179 Liberation and the destruction of sin are only incidental fruits of the Name. The example is the light of the sun.

180 “As the sun, merely by rising, dispels an ocean of darkness, so the Name of Hari, rising even once, destroys all the sins of all people. All glory to that Name of Hari, the blessing of the world!” (Padyāvalī, 16)

181 O scholars, explain the meaning of this verse.” They all said, “You explain its meaning.”

182–183 Haridāsa said, “When the sun rises, darkness begins to vanish even before it has risen, and the fear of thieves, ghosts, Rākṣasas and the like comes to an end. When it has risen, religious duties, works and all else come to light.

184 In the same way, as the Name begins to rise, sins and the like are destroyed; when it has risen, love for Kṛṣṇa’s feet dawns.

185 Liberation is a trifling fruit that comes from the mere semblance of the Name (*nāmābhāsa*). Kṛṣṇa wishes to give that liberation, but His devotee does not accept it.

186 “Even Ajāmila, who uttered the Name of Hari at the moment of death while calling his son, went to the Lord’s abode. What then of one who chants it with faith?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 6.2.49)

187 “My devotees accept nothing but service to Me — not even when they are offered residence in My world, opulence equal to Mine, nearness to Me, a form like Mine, or even oneness with Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.13)

188 There was a man named Gopāla Cakravartī, the chief tax collector (*ārindā*) of the Majumadāras’ house.

189 Living in Gauḍa, he worked as tax collector for the Pātsāhā and paid twelve lakhs (1,200,000) of coins to the Pātsāhā.

190 He was very handsome, learned and in the first bloom of youth. Hearing that liberation comes from the semblance of the Name, he could not tolerate it.

191 Becoming angry, he spoke wrathful words: “Hear the conclusion of this sentimentalist, O scholars!

192 The liberation that is not attained by knowledge of Brahman even in ten million births — that liberation, he says, comes from the mere semblance of the Name!”

193 Haridāsa said, “Why do you doubt? The scriptures say that liberation comes from the mere semblance of the Name.

194 Before the happiness of devotion, liberation is utterly trifling; therefore the devotees do not accept it.

195 “O Guru of the world, now that I am immersed in the pure ocean of joy that comes from seeing You face to face, all other joys — even the bliss of Brahman — seem to me like the water in a calf’s hoofprint.” (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 14.36)

196 The brāhmaṇa said, “If liberation does not come from the semblance of the Name, then let it be settled: your nose will be cut off!”

197 Haridāsa said, “If liberation does not come from the semblance of the Name, then I shall cut off my own nose — that is certain.”

198 Hearing this, the members of the assembly rose with an outcry, and the Majumadāras rebuked that brāhmaṇa.

199 The priest Balāi (Balarāma) reproached him: “You are a fool who argues about pots and cloth (*ghaṭa-paṭiyā*) — what do you know of

devotion?

200 You have insulted Haridāsa Ṭhākura! You will be utterly ruined; no good will come to you.”

201 Hearing this, Haridāsa rose and departed, and the Majumadāras dismissed that brāhmaṇa.

202 Together with the whole assembly they fell at Haridāsa’s feet, and Haridāsa, smiling, spoke sweet words:

203 “None of you is at fault, nor is this ignorant brāhmaṇa to blame: his mind is devoted to logic.

204 The greatness of the Name lies beyond the reach of logic. How could he know these truths?

205 Go home. May Kṛṣṇa bless you all, and may no one suffer on my account.”

206 Then Hiraṇya dāsa returned to his own house and forbade that brāhmaṇa to enter his door.

207 Within three days that brāhmaṇa contracted leprosy, and his very prominent nose rotted and fell off.

208 His fingers and toes, once like campaka buds, all shrivelled and rotted away with leprosy.

209 Seeing this, everyone was amazed; they praised Haridāsa and bowed down to him.

210 Although Haridāsa did not take the brāhmaṇa's offence to heart, the Lord nevertheless made him taste its fruit.

211 It is the nature of a devotee to forgive the faults of the ignorant; it is Kṛṣṇa's nature that He cannot bear blasphemy of His devotee.

212 Hearing of the brāhmaṇa's suffering, Haridāsa was saddened at heart. Taking leave of the priest Balāi, he came to Śāntipura.

213 Meeting the Ācārya, he fell before Him in obeisance, and Advaita embraced him and honoured him.

214 On the bank of the Gaṅgā He made a secluded cave-dwelling for him, and He explained to him the devotional meaning of the *Bhāgavata* and the *Gītā*.

215 He took his alms daily at the Ācārya's house, and together the two of them relished talks about Kṛṣṇa.

216 Haridāsa said, "Gosāñi, I have something to submit to You. Why do You give me food every day?

217 Here are great brāhmaṇas, a society of the high-born, and yet You honour me and feel no shame!

218 Your conduct is extraordinary; I am afraid even to speak of it. Please be merciful and act so that Your own standing is protected."

219 The Ācārya said, "Do not be afraid. I shall act only as the scriptures direct.

220 When you eat, it is as good as feeding ten million brāhmaṇas." Saying this, He fed him the *śrāddha-pātra*, the food of the day of *śrāddha*.

221 He was always thinking of how to deliver the world: “How will this world, devoid of Vaiṣṇavas, be delivered?”

222 Advaita vowed to bring Kṛṣṇa down to this world, and He began to worship Him with water and *tulasī*.

223 In his cave Haridāsa chanted the Name, with this one thought in his mind: “Kṛṣṇa will descend.”

224 By the devotion of these two Caitanya descended, and by preaching the Name and love He delivered the world.

225 There is another extraordinary deed of his, which amazes people when they hear it.

226 Do not argue: his ways are beyond argument. Hear it with faith and conviction.

227 One day Haridāsa was sitting in his cave, chanting the Name aloud.

228 It was a moonlit night; the ten directions were perfectly clear, and the waves of the Gaṅgā glittered in the moonlight.

229 At the door was Tulasī, on a plastered platform. Seeing the beauty of the cave, anyone’s heart was soothed.

230 At that time a woman came into the courtyard, and the lustre of her body turned the whole place golden.

231 The fragrance of her body perfumed the ten directions, and the tinkling of her ornaments startled the ears.

232 Coming in, she bowed down to Tulasī, circumambulated her and went to the door of the cave.

233 With joined palms she honoured Haridāsa's feet, and sitting at the door, she spoke some sweet words:

234 "You are the friend of the whole world, endowed with beauty and virtue. I have come here for your company.

235 Be kind and accept me. To show mercy to the lowly — that is the nature of a saint."

236 Saying this, she displayed various alluring moods, the sight of which would make even a sage lose his composure.

237 But Haridāsa, unmoved and deep of heart, began to speak to her kindly:

238 "Chanting the Name by a fixed count is what I consider the great sacrifice (*mahā-yajña*), and every day I am consecrated to it.

239 Until the chanting is complete, I do nothing else; when the chanting is complete, my vow is at rest.

240 Sit at the door and listen to the chanting of the Name. When the Name is completed, I shall do what pleases you."

241 Saying this, he went on chanting the Name, and the woman sat and listened to the holy Name.

242 While he chanted, morning came, and seeing that it was morning, the woman rose and left.

243 In this way she came for three days, displaying moods that could captivate even Brahmā's mind.

244 Haridāsa's mind was always absorbed in the Name of Kṛṣṇa, so her display of feminine charms was like crying in the wilderness.

245 When the third night was coming to an end, the woman said to the Ṭhākura:

246 "For three days you have deceived me with promises. Night and day, your chanting of the Name never ends."

247 Haridāsa Ṭhākura said, "What can I do? I have made a vow — how can I give it up?"

248 Then, bowing down to him, the woman said, "I am Māyā. I came to test you.

249 I have bewitched all living beings, beginning with Brahmā; you alone I could not bewitch.

250–251 You are a great devotee (*mahā-bhāgavata*). By seeing you and hearing you chant Kṛṣṇa's Name, my heart has become pure and longs to take Kṛṣṇa's Name. Be merciful to me: instruct me in Kṛṣṇa's Name.

252 In the descent of Caitanya a flood of the nectar of love is flowing. All living beings float in that love, and the earth has become blessed.

253 Wretched is the soul who does not float in this flood: for him there is no deliverance even in millions of *kalpas*.

254 Long ago I received the Name of Rāma from Śiva; now, by your company, I long to take the Name of Kṛṣṇa.

255 The Name of Rāma is the *tāraka-brahma*, the Brahman that delivers, the cause of liberation; the Name of Kṛṣṇa, the *pāraka*, carries one across and gives love.

256 Give me Kṛṣṇa's Name and make me blessed, so that this flood of love may sweep me away too."

257 Saying this, she honoured Haridāsa's feet. Haridāsa said, "Chant the Name of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana*)."

258 Having received his instruction, Māyā departed, pleased. Yet some people do not believe such accounts.

259 To make them believe, I shall tell the reason for it; hearing it, everyone will have faith.

260 At the descent of Caitanya, Brahmā, Śiva, Sanaka and the others, eager for love of Kṛṣṇa, took birth on earth.

261 Taking Kṛṣṇa's Name, they dance and float in the flood of love. Nārada, Prahlāda and others came in human form.

262 Lakṣmī and others, eager for love of Kṛṣṇa, took birth as human beings and relished the Name and love.

263 What to speak of others? The son of the king of Vraja Himself descends and relishes love and the Name.

264 If Māyā, the Lord's maidservant, begs for love, what wonder is there in that? Without the mercy of a saint and the Name, love is never born.

265 Such is the very nature of Caitanya Gosāñi's pastimes: the three worlds dance and sing, having attained the mood of love.

266 Kṛṣṇa Himself and the others, and all beings, moving and unmoving — *kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana* makes them all mad with love of Kṛṣṇa.

267 The pastimes that Svarūpa Gosāñi recorded in his notebook (*kaḍacā*), and all that I heard from the mouth of Raghunātha dāsa —

268 those pastimes I tell in brief. Though I am an insignificant soul, I write by Caitanya's mercy.

269 I have told a particle of the glory of Haridāsa Ṭhākura; hearing it soothes the devotees' ears.

270 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.